

stronger guarantee

more flexibility

Structured out-puts / strict: true
grammar-constrained decoding

schema-valid *except* refusals and `max_tokens` cutoffs, over the supported schema subset

tool_choice + strict
force the call, guarantee the args

a call *is* emitted; `strict` makes its arguments conform

Validation + retry loop
re-prompt on mismatch

no prevention — *recovers* after an invalid output (bounded retries)

Prompt-asked JSON
specify format, stop sequence

no guarantee — shapes likelihood, not the token grammar